

HOLY SPRINKLE A purification ritual, 'shanti homam', being done on the Tirumala laddus

TIRUPATI LADDU UNDER THE SCANNER

The mahaprasadam made the news after a fake ghee scare

- **Controversy erupts in mid-'24 after samples from ghee tankers test positive for foreign fats**
- **New CM Naidu alleges animal fat used, blames previous Jagan regime; SC orders CBI-led probe**
- **SIT chargesheets 36 TTD officials, dairy owners; Naidu brings up Jagan's Christian faith, alleges communal angle**
- **SIT report in Jan. '26 says 'no animal fat' but ghee adulterated; Rs 234 cr. scam began in 2019, 6 mn kgs of fake ghee procured**
- **TDP-YSRCP still at each other's throats, but Tirupati laddu sales at all-time high**

Pawan Kalyan of the Jana Sena Party, that animal fat was used in the ghee but it did put YSRCP leaders such as Y.V. Subba Reddy and Bhumana Karunakar Reddy, who were chairing the TTD at the time, in the dock. The SIT report charged that certain private dairy companies engaged by the TTD connived with employees and the dairy experts engaged by the trust, causing the Rs 234 crore loss. Per the report, firms like Dindigul-based AR Dairy had been engaged to supply ghee at a mere Rs 320 per kg, an unviable price.

The controversy erupted after the National Dairy Development Board (NDDB) CALF lab detected inferior quality ghee collected from four tankers supplied by AR Dairy in July 2024. The SIT was formed pursuant to the Supreme Court orders in October 2024, following Naidu's 'animal fat' claims that caused nationwide uproar. That claim did not go far, but the lab investigations did find evidence of the use of vegetable oils and certain chemical and synthetic elements.

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> **N. CHANDRABABU NAIDU**
> *Chief Minister, Andhra Pradesh*



JAGAN'S OTHER FAITH

Animal fat or not, Naidu has been claiming for some time now that the YSRCP was aware of the ghee adulteration, and that quality standards dipped and complaints about the laddu quality were ignored when Subba Reddy was TTD chairman.

A Central Food Technological Research Institute (CFTRI) lab report confirming the presence of plant sterol Beta-sitosterol was shared with Subba Reddy in August 2022 but was suppressed by him, alleges Naidu. The CM also claims Subba Reddy's then PA, Kaduru Chinnappanna, one of the 36 accused chargesheeted, had demanded commissions of Rs 25 per kg from some suppliers. Among the other accused are the directors of Bhole Baba Organic Dairy, AR Dairy and Sri Vyshnavi Dairy.

Subba Reddy, who is Jagan's uncle and a Rajya Sabha member, was TTD chairman from 2019 to 2023. Though Subba Reddy is a Hindu, Naidu, in his assembly speech, raked up Jagan's Christian faith to say how, as CM, he flouted the Tirumala entry rule, taking darshan at the temple without signing the declaration of faith non-Hindus require for the purpose. "Their conspiracy/machinations didn't just stop at ghee, there was a systematic attack on religion, faith and our emotions," alleges Naidu. He cited the theft of devotees' offerings from the *parakamani* (the hundi donations counting centre), alleged proselytisa-